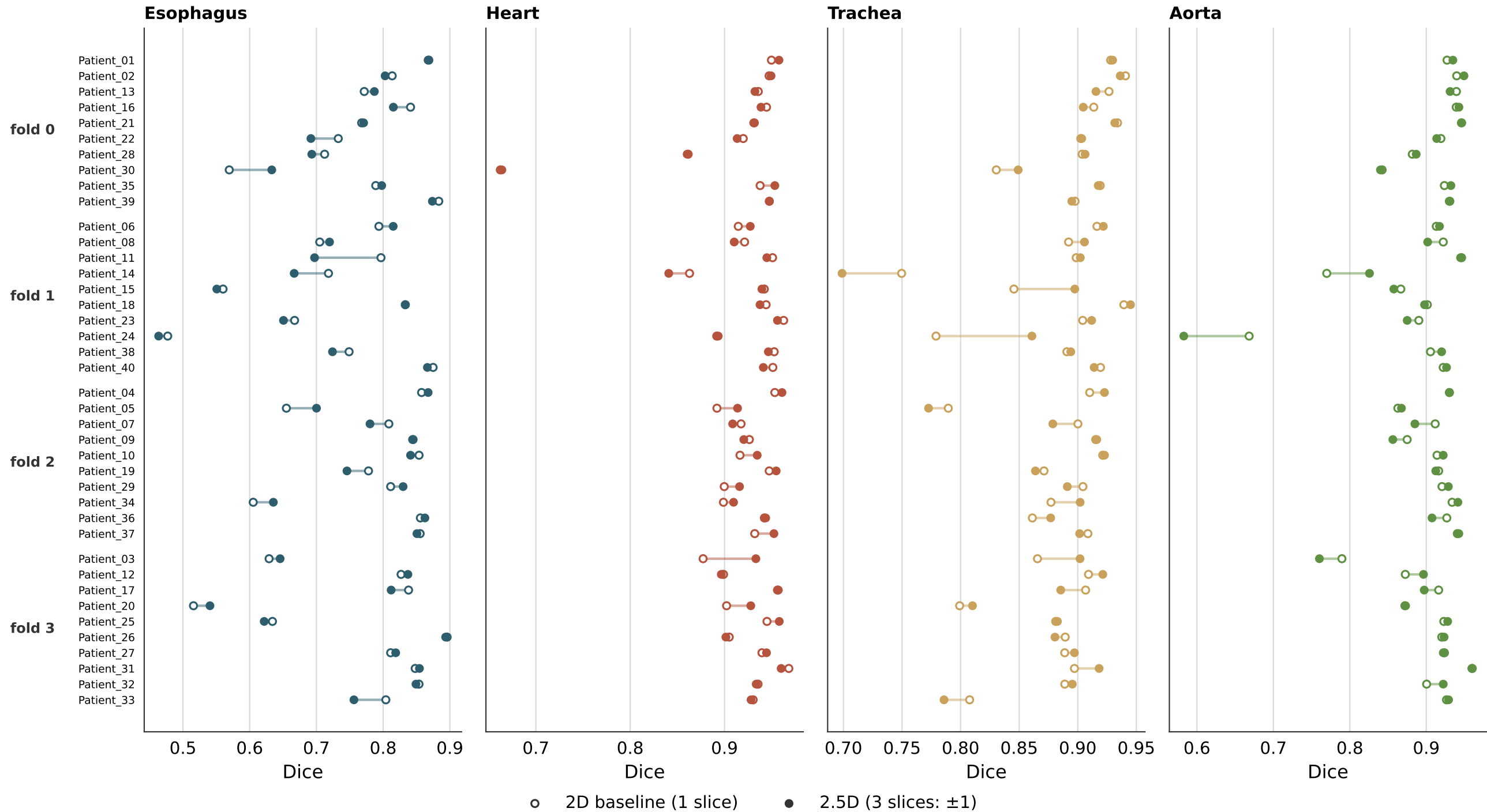


Per-patient Dice, 2D baseline (1 slice) and 2.5D (3 slices: ± 1)

40 patients, one row each, grouped by fold (4-fold cross-validation). Residual-encoder U-Net with deep supervision, 40-patient SEGTHOR train set (corrected labels), median spacing + HU window + z-score + ROI crop, CE + soft Dice loss. 2.5D = the slice and its ± 1 neighbours as 3 input channels, centre slice predicted



Each patient's 3D Dice (best checkpoint) averaged over 3 seeds.